

Cybersecurity Daily Newsletter

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Top 5 Highlights

- Malicious Custom GPTs Turn ChatGPT Into RAT Delivery Lure
- South African air traffic control firm investigates ransomware-linked malware in OT network
- High-severity OpenSSL flaw can leak memory or crash programs
- Russia proposes new rules to curb SIM card fraud
- UK employers plan tech team expansion, prioritizing security and AI skills

Threat Intelligence (10)

01. Malicious Custom GPTs Turn ChatGPT Into RAT Delivery Lure

In yet another ClickFix-style campaign, threat actors abuse legitimate domains from OpenAI and Google to fool unsuspecting users.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cyberattacks-data-breaches/malicious-custom-gpts-chatgpt-rat-delivery-lure>

02. Russian state hackers use new RedFlick technique to push malware

The Russian state actor Star Blizzard has been using a new malware installation tactic dubbed "RedFlick" to deploy its signature CosmicPulse backdoor. [...]

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/russian-state-hackers-use-new-redflick-technique-to-push-malware/>

03. Attackers Abuse MSP360 to Deploy ScreenConnect in Dual-RMM Phishing Attacks

Microsoft has warned of phishing campaigns distributing an installer for the MSP360 Remote Monitoring and Management (RMM) software under the guise of meeting invitations, PDF-themed lures, software update prompts, and other social-engineering content. "Once executed, the legitimate MSP360 installer, distributed under a deceptive file name established remot...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/attackers-abuse-msp360-to-deploy.html>

04. Russia's Star Blizzard Ditches ClickFix to Widen Phishing Net

The APT actor is using a new tactic, dubbed "RedFlick," against Ukrainian-linked targets such as NGOs, think tanks, and journalists to deploy its CosmicPulse backdoor.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/threat-intelligence/russia-star-blizzard-apt-ditches-clickfix-widen-phishing-net>

05. Attackers Abuse ChatGPT Custom GPTs to Deliver RAT via ClickFix Lures

Threat actors are abusing ChatGPT Custom GPTs to disguise them as legitimate product offerings and direct unsuspecting victims to malicious sites that employ ClickFix lures to deliver malware. Huntress, which observed the activity in late September 2026, said it marks the abuse of yet another feature in trusted artificial intelligence (AI) platforms. Prior...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/attackers-abuse-chatgpt-custom-gpts-to.html>

06. Attackers Combine ChatGPT Feature Abuse With ClickFix to Deliver Trojan Malware

Cybersecurity researchers at Huntress identify campaign to deliver potent trojan which targets users searching for ChatGPT via Google

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/chatgpt-feature-abuse-to-deliver/>

07. Russian APT Star Blizzard Uses 'RedFlick' Infection Chain in Recent Attacks

The state-sponsored group has launched larger-scale phishing campaigns to deploy the CosmicPulse backdoor. The post Russian APT Star Blizzard Uses 'RedFlick' Infection Chain in Recent Attacks appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources:

<https://www.securityweek.com/russian-apt-star-blizzard-uses-redflick-infection-chain-in-recent-attacks/>

08. US-Focused CSuite Phishing Steals Microsoft 365 Sessions and Deploys RMM Tools for Remote Access

ANY.RUN researchers traced a US-focused CSuite phishing campaign across 351 sandbox analyses, with 51% of submissions coming from the United States. Technology, manufacturing, government, and consulting organizations showed the highest exposure. By combining Microsoft 365 session theft with remote-access tool deployment, CSuite can turn a phishing incident...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/us-focused-csuite-phishing-steals.html>

09. More than half of UK businesses lack confidence in basic cyber skills

Government survey puts the figure at 808k, says detecting and removing malware most common weakness

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/security/2026/09/30/more-than-half-of-uk-businesses-lack-confidence-in-basic-cyber-skills/5299991>

10. [+24h Old] Phishing Response Protocol: 3 Essential SOC Steps Powered by ANY.RUN's Latest Updates

Phishing investigations put pressure on SOC teams at several points at once: analysts need to uncover hidden activity, make a confident decision from incomplete evidence, prepare the case for escalation, and then determine whether the threat extends beyond a single incident. Every manual step adds time to the response. It also ties up analyst capacity [...] T...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://any.run/cybersecurity-blog/phishing-response-protocol/>

Latest Vulnerabilities (10)

01. High-severity OpenSSL flaw can leak memory or crash programs

The vulnerability arises in the Datagram Transport Layer Security (DTLS) protocol, a variant of TLS used for UDP traffic.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/high-severity-openssl-flaw-can-leak-memory-or-crash-programs>

02. UK employers plan tech team expansion, prioritizing security and AI skills

Research from Robert Half indicates that 47% of UK employers intend to increase their tech workforce.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.scworld.com/brief/uk-employers-plan-tech-team-expansion-prioritizing-security-and-ai-skills>

03. Microsoft Entra ID to enhance security against script injection attacks

Starting mid-October 2026, Microsoft will enforce stricter Content Security Policy (CSP) defenses within Entra ID sign-ins.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.scworld.com/brief/microsoft-entra-id-to-enhance-security-against-script-injection-attacks>

04. Threat Brief: NetScaler Zero Days CVE-2026-88771 and CVE-2026-88772 Exploited in the Wild (Updated September 30)

Unit 42 is aware of possible 0-day activity against NetScaler devices. Citrix reports CVE-2026-88771, CVE-2026-88772 have been exploited in the wild. The post Threat Brief: NetScaler Zero Days CVE-2026-88771 and CVE-2026-88772 Exploited in the Wild (Updated September 30) appeared first on Unit 42 .

Why it matters: Publicly discussed 0-days often see rapid weaponization, increasing the risk of opportunistic attacks at scale.

Recommendation: Apply vendor guidance immediately, reduce attack surface, and monitor for IoCs/exploitation telemetry until patches are fully deployed.

Sources: <https://unit42.paloaltonetworks.com/netscaler-zero-days-exploited/>

05. DIVD says Zammad zero-days enabled AI-driven network breach

The Dutch Institute for Vulnerability Disclosure (DIVD) says that the breach of its network was possible by exploiting a chain of two zero-day vulnerabilities in the open-source Zammad ticketing system. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/divd-says-zammad-zero-days-enabled-ai-driven-network-breach/>

06. Attackers Exploit Zimbra Flaw to Deploy Web Shells and Harvest Authentication Secrets

Threat actors have weaponized a now-patched security flaw in Zimbra Collaboration Suite (ZCS) to deploy web shells and access mailbox data, according to findings from the

Microsoft Security Research team. The attack exploits CVE-2026-73570 (CVSS score: 8.9), an unauthenticated operating system command injection flaw that can lead to remote code execution wh...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/attackers-exploit-zimbra-flaw-to-deploy.html>

07. CISA warns of critical pre-auth RCE flaw in MikroTik RouterOS

The U.S. Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA) is warning of a new critical vulnerability in MikroTik RouterOS that could lead to remote code execution or cause a denial-of-service condition. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/cisa-warns-of-critical-pre-auth-rce-flaw-in-mikrotik-routeros/>

08. Cisco Warns of Attackers Exploiting Critical Authentication Bypass in SD-WAN Manager

Attackers are exploiting a new critical zero-day flaw in Cisco Catalyst SD-WAN Manager, the system companies use to manage their Cisco SD-WAN networks, Cisco said in an advisory on September 30. The flaw, CVE-2026-76504, could allow a remote attacker with no login access to use the Manager's API as the admin user. Fixed releases are available, and there is...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/cisco-warns-of-attackers-exploiting.html>

09. Cisco warns of new SD-WAN zero-day exploited in attacks

Cisco released security updates to address a critical zero-day in the Catalyst SD-WAN Manager (tracked as CVE-2026-76504) that attackers are actively exploiting to escalate to admin privileges. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/cisco-warns-of-new-sd-wan-authentication-bypass-zero-day-exploited-in-attacks/>

10. Google: AI Is Changing the Pace and Profile of Vulnerability Discovery

Google's analysis found that AI-discovered vulnerabilities are more likely to enable remote code execution. The post Google: AI Is Changing the Pace and Profile of Vulnerability Discovery appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.securityweek.com/google-ai-is-changing-the-pace-and-profile-of-vulnerability-discovery/>

Data Breach & Cybercrime (10)

01. South African air traffic control firm investigates ransomware-linked malware in OT network

The incident at ATNS, which manages approximately 10% of the world's airspace, involved suspicious activity detected in OT environments supporting weather services.

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/south-african-air-traffic-control-firm-investigates-ransomware-linked-malware-in-ot-network>

02. Russia proposes new rules to curb SIM card fraud

The proposed measures would restrict SIM card registration to direct dealers and mandate that new SIM cards be sold without any pre-loaded funds.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/russia-proposes-new-rules-to-curb-sim-card-fraud>

03. Over 543,000 valid credentials exposed in public GitHub repositories

More than 543,000 credentials exposed in public GitHub repositories were still valid in July despite the platform's security measures to prevent accidental leaks of sensitive data. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/over-543-000-valid-credentials-exposed-in-public-github-repositories/>

04. Know Your Enemy: Browser-Based Attack Techniques in 2026

Given that the browser is where business apps are accessed and used, it makes sense that attacks are happening there too. Most breaches today begin in a browser session. Often, they never leave it, with the entire attack chain from initial access to exfiltration playing out in the browser. Here are the six most dangerous techniques that should be on every s...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/know-your-enemy-browser-based-attack.html>

05. ShinyHunters Defiant After FBI Calls on Members to Come Forward

In the wake of a suspected leader's arrest, ShinyHunters says it never intended to publish data stolen from the FBI. The post ShinyHunters Defiant After FBI Calls on Members to Come Forward appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources:

<https://www.securityweek.com/shinyhunters-defiant-after-fbi-calls-on-members-to-come-forward/>

06. The MFA you have isn't the MFA you think you have

For nearly a decade, multi-factor authentication has been the control every security leader points to when asked how they've reduced account takeover risk. It sits on almost every compliance checklist and nearly every cyber insurance questionnaire, and for good reason - adding a second factor to a password login closed off an enormous share of credential-ba...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources:

<https://www.csoonline.com/article/4228386/the-mfa-you-have-isnt-the-mfa-you-think-you-have.html>

07. [+24h Old] Can we jail a superintelligence?

AI containment is essential, but security leaders should assume every boundary can fail once an agent can communicate, use tools, and act on real systems. On September 17, podcaster Steven Bartlett asked four AI experts an unusual question: Could you build a jail for a digital Einstein? The panel on The Diary of a CEO was debating whether AI could one day t...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.csoononline.com/article/4228309/can-we-jail-a-superintelligence.html>

08. [+24h Old] OpenSSL Fixes High-Severity DTLS Flaw That Can Leak Heap Memory Unencrypted

A High-severity OpenSSL flaw can leak heap memory to the other side of a DTLS connection or crash the program, OpenSSL said on September 29 as it released fixes. DTLS, the TLS variant used for UDP traffic, resends a handshake message if no reply arrives before the timer expires. The leak or crash can happen when such a resend starts while a larger handshake...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/openssl-fixes-high-severity-dtls-flaw.html>

09. [+24h Old] South Africa Seeks Help After Cyberattack Targets Air Traffic Control

As aviation infrastructure suffers more cyberattacks, air traffic systems are the latest target, with a ransomware toolkit installed on at least one operational network.

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cyberattacks-data-breaches/south-africa-help-cyberattack-air-traffic-control>

10. [+24h Old] FBI tells ShinyHunters members to turn themselves in after recent arrest

The FBI is warning members of the ShinyHunters extortion group to turn themselves in after Dutch police arrested a man the bureau described as one of the group's alleged leaders. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/fbi-tells-shinyhunters-members-to-turn-themselves-in-after-recent-arrest/>